

Chapter 36

Editing Basics

In this chapter, you'll learn many of the fundamental methods and commands you'll use when beginning to assemble clips into the Timeline.

This includes drag and drop operations to begin assembling a timeline, different ways of selecting and deselecting the clips you've edited in preparation for different tasks, maintaining sync between the audio and video components of clips you're editing, and deleting clips and gaps you don't want.

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Keyboard Shortcuts in This Chapter

Here's a list of keyboard shortcuts you might find helpful that relate to topics found in this chapter.

Key Shortcut	Function
V	Select nearest edit to playhead
Shift-V	Select clip intersecting playhead
U	Select incoming, outgoing, or centered part of edit
Option-U	Toggle selection among video+audio, video only, and audio only
Option-Y	Select clips forward (of the playhead) on all tracks
Command-Option-Y	Select clips backward (of the playhead) on all tracks
Y	Select clips forward (of the playhead) on current track
Command-Y	Select clips backward (of the playhead) on current track
Up, Down Arrow Keys	Move selection to previous/next edit or clip
Delete	Delete clip and leave gap (lift edit)
Forward Delete	Ripple delete; deletes a clip and moves the rest of the timeline left to fill the gap
Command-Backslash (\)	Insert edit; adds a cut to the clip(s) at the position of the playhead

Key Shortcut	Function
N	Toggle timeline snapping off and on
Command-Shift-L	Toggle linked selection off and on
Option-1 through 8	Set video destination control to that track number; press again to enable/disable
Command-Option-1 through 8	Set audio destination control to that track number; press again to enable/disable
Option-Shift-1 through 8	Toggle lock for individual video tracks
Option-Shift-9	Toggle lock for all video tracks
Option-Shift-F1 through F8	Toggle lock for individual audio tracks
Option-Shift-F9	Toggle lock for all audio tracks
F9	Insert Edit selected clip(s) from Media Pool or Source Viewer to the Timeline
F10	Overwrite Edit selected clip(s) from Media Pool or Source Viewer to the Timeline
F11	Replace Edit the first of selected clip(s) from Media Pool or Source Viewer to the Timeline
F12	Place On Top Edit from Media Pool or Source Viewer to the Timeline
Shift-F10	Ripple Overwrite from Media Pool or Source Viewer to the Timeline
Shift-F11	Fit to Fill from Media Pool or Source Viewer to the Timeline
Shift-F12	Append To End Edit from Media Pool or Source Viewer to the Timeline
Undo	Command-Z
Redo	Command-Shift-Z

Drag and Drop Editing

If you've already used other editing programs, the procedures in this section will almost certainly be remedial, but if you're new to editing, this section covers the most basic methods of editing a series of clips into the Timeline to get you started. The absolute simplest method of editing is to drag clips from the Media Pool and drop them into the Timeline. You can do this with individual clips, or with selected groups of clips.

Drag and Drop Editing of Individual Clips Into the Timeline

If you're just editing one clip at a time to create an edited sequence in a timeline, this is how that works.

- 1 If you need to edit specific ranges of the clips you're editing, you can set In and Out points in source clips first by doing one of the following:

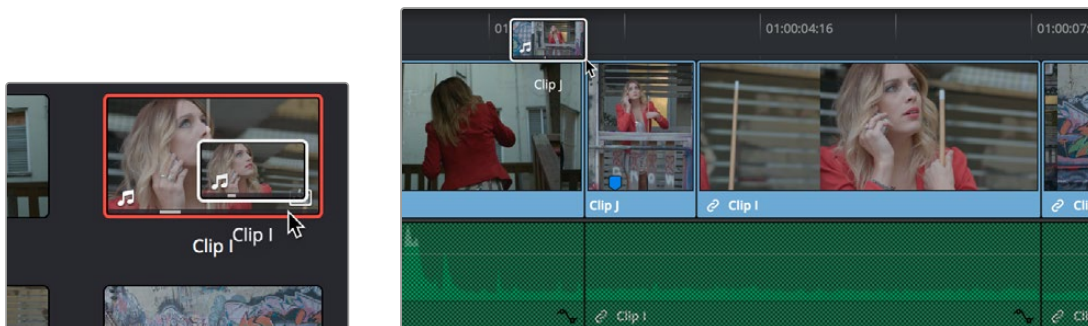
Setting In and Out points while skimming a thumbnail in the Metadata View: As you're skimming over a clip's thumbnail in the Viewer, press I and O to set In and Out points to encompass the part of that clip you're going to want to use. If you've turned on Live Media Preview in the Source Viewer, then the Source Viewer will show what you're skimming so you can get a closer look. If you don't like the current In and Out points, you can press Option-X to clear them both.

Setting In and Out points while skimming a thumbnail in the Media Pool: As you're skimming over a clip's thumbnail in the Viewer, press I and O to set In and Out points to encompass the part of that clip you're going to want to use. If you've turned on Live Media Preview in the Source Viewer, then the Source Viewer will show what you're skimming so you can get a closer look. When you're finished, that clip's thumbnail will show a range indicator at the bottom to show how much of the clip you've selected. If you don't like the current In and Out points, you can press Option-X to clear them both.

Using the Media Pool Filmstrip in the Media Pool's List view: Set the Media Pool to List view, select Show Filmstrip in the option menu, then select a clip to expose it in the Filmstrip at the top of the Media Pool, drag the pointer through the Filmstrip to watch it play and press I and O to set In and Out points to the appropriate range. The Filmstrip will dim the heads and tails to let you see the range of media you've marked. If you've turned on Live Media Preview in the Source Viewer, then the Source Viewer will show what you're skimming so you can get a closer look. If you don't like the current In and Out points, you can press Option-X to clear them both.

Using the Source Viewer: Open a clip in the Viewer by double-clicking it in the Media Pool, or by selecting it in the Media Pool and pressing the Return or Enter key. Then use the transport controls, jog bar, control panel buttons, Spacebar, or JKL commands to move the playhead, and place In and Out points using the In and Out buttons to the right of the transport controls, or by pressing the I or O keys. If you don't like the current In and Out points, you can press Option-X to clear them both.

- 2 Drag the clip you want to edit from either the Media Pool or the Source Viewer, and drop it onto the desired position in the Timeline to perform an overwrite edit. If you drag a clip on top of another clip that's already in the Timeline, the clip you're dragging will overwrite the part of the clip that it overlaps.



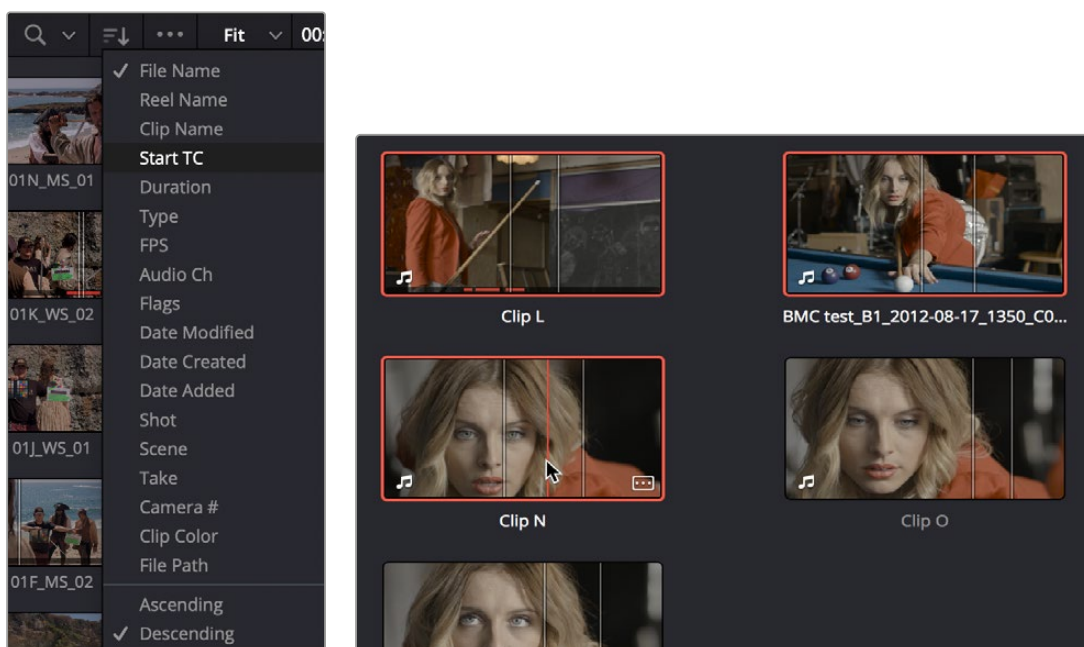
Dragging a clip from the Media Pool to overwrite a clip in the Timeline

TIP: If you drag a clip into the blank area above an existing video track or below an existing audio track, a new track will automatically be created.

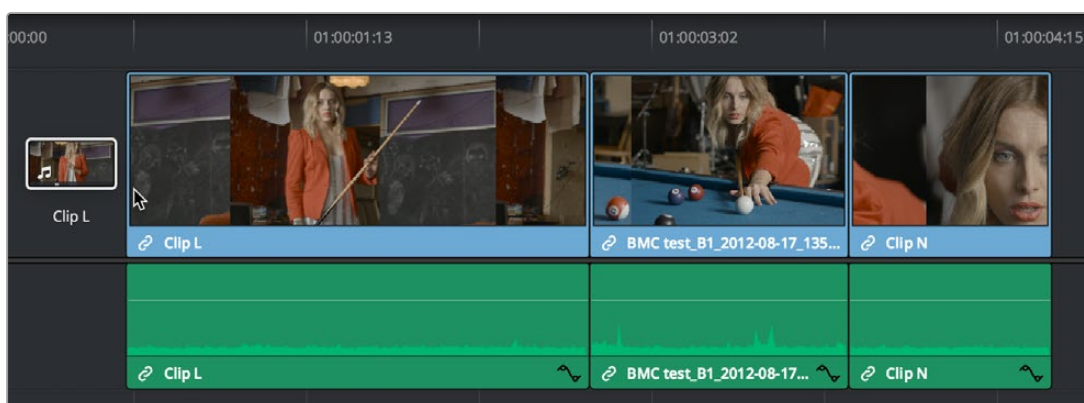
Drag and Drop Editing of Several Clips Into the Timeline At Once

The procedure above also works when you want to edit several clips into the Timeline at once by dragging them from the Media Pool.

- 1 Change the sort order of the Media Pool's browser area to put the clips into the order in which you want them to appear. In Thumbnail view you can use the Sort Order menu, but in List view you can click the header of any metadata column to sort by that column's data. If you've used the Metadata Editor to add Scene, Shot, Take, or other information to identify each clip, you can sort by these metadata criteria.
- 2 Use the Media Pool thumbnails, the Media Pool List view Filmstrip, or the Source Viewer to set In and Out points to define the part of each clip that you want to edit into the Timeline.
- 3 Select the Media Pool clips you want to edit into the Timeline by dragging a bounding box, Command-dragging multiple bounding boxes over different sets of clips, by Shift-clicking a range of clips, or by Command-clicking individual non-contiguous clips.
- 4 Drag any of the selected clips to the desired position in the Timeline to perform an overwrite edit.



Using the Sort Order menu to change the sort order of clips in the Media Pool



Dragging multiple clips into the Timeline in the sort order of the Media Pool

The clip(s) you drag overwrite whatever other clips they overlap in the Timeline. Multiple clips dragged from the Media Pool will be edited in the order in which they're sorted in the Media Pool, using each clip's In and Out points.

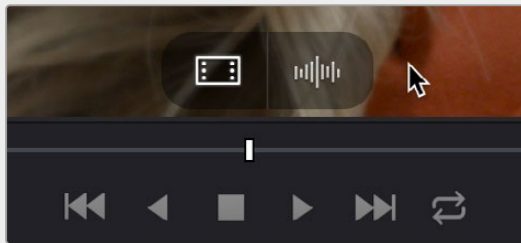
Drag and Drop Editing of Video-Only or Audio-Only Edits

While it's easy to edit just the video or just the audio of a clip by disabling the audio or video destination control in the Timeline prior to doing any sort of edit (described later in Chapter 39, "Three- and Four-Point Editing"), there's also a pair of keyboard modifiers you can use to do the very same thing while you're dragging.

To edit only the video of a clip from the Media Pool: Option-drag clips from the Media Pool/Filmstrip, Source Viewer, or Finder into the Timeline.

To edit only the audio of a clip from the Media Pool: Shift-drag clips from the Media Pool/Filmstrip, Source Viewer, or Finder into the Timeline.

To edit only the video or audio of a clip from the Source Viewer: Open a clip into the Source Viewer, then move the pointer over the Source Viewer and drag from either the Video-only or Audio-only overlays that appear over the bottom of the image.



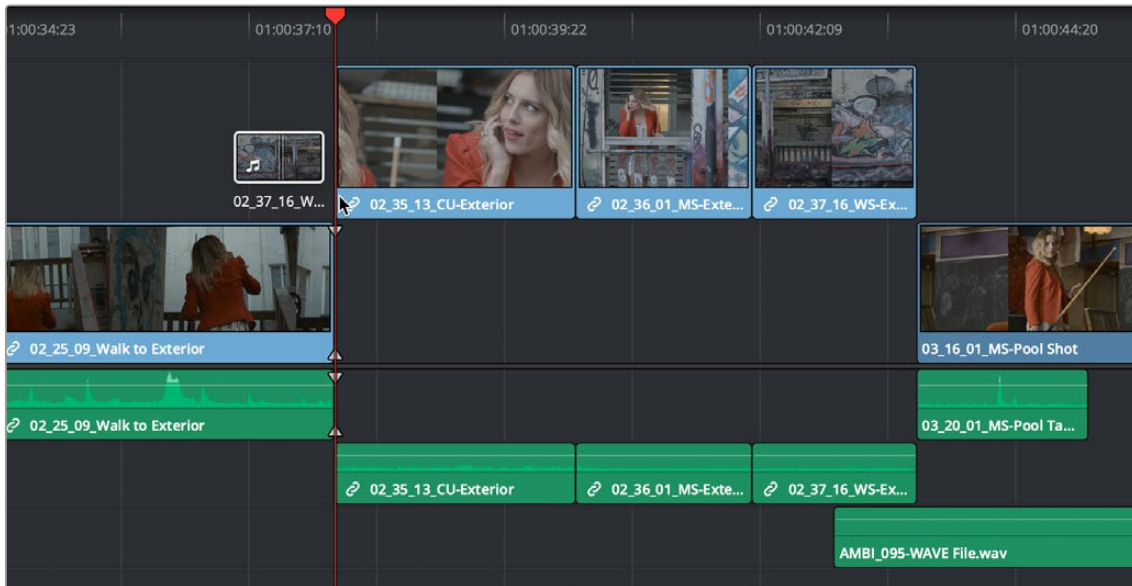
Video and Audio-only overlay controls appear in the Source Viewer that let you drag just the video or just the audio into the Timeline

Drag and Drop Insert Editing

You can also drag multiple clips from the Timeline, or a single clip from the Source Viewer, at any frame of the current timeline to either insert the selection between any two clips or to insert it in the middle of an existing clip, moving (actually rippling) all media to the right of the new edit point you create to make room for the new incoming media.

To shuffle insert multiple clips from the Media Pool or Source Viewer into the Timeline:

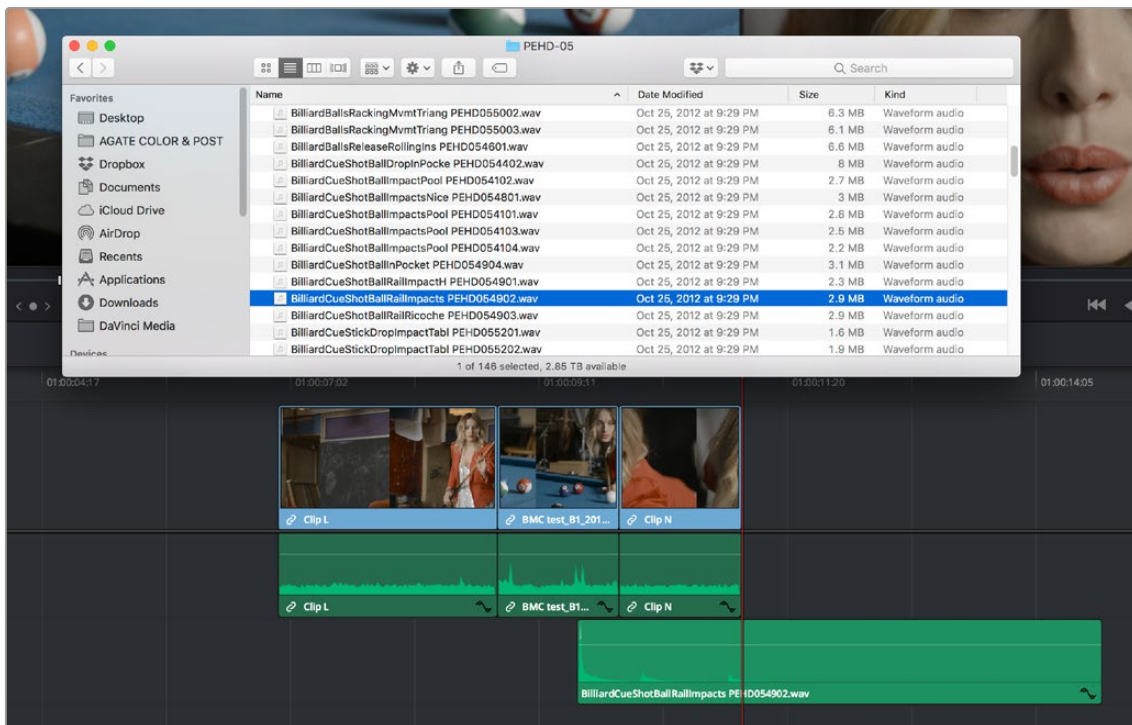
- 1 Select one or more clips in the Media Pool (the sort order dictates the final order of the edited clips), or open a clip in the Source Viewer.
- 2 Press and hold the Command and Shift keys, and drag the selection from the Media Pool or Source Viewer into the Timeline.
- 3 As you drag, the clips you're dragging will be inserted into the Timeline at the pointer location. Release the mouse to finish making the edit.



Making an Insert Edit while dragging clips from the Media Pool

Dragging Clips From the File System Into the Timeline

You can also drag a clip directly from your file system to the Timeline on supported platforms.



Dragging multiple clips into the Timeline from the macOS Finder

Inserting Multiple Clips into the Timeline From the Media Pool

For certain large volume editing projects, you can insert multiple clips from the Media Pool into a timeline all at once. The parameters for the order and positioning of the clips depend on the method used.

Insert Selected Clips to Timeline Using Timecode

Clips can now be edited directly from the Media Pool into a timeline, such that each clip's source timecode is aligned with an identical record timecode value in the Timeline. This can be useful for long form multi-camera events, like weddings or concerts, where all cameras are linked by the same timecode to ensure all edits are perfectly synced. This function matches the Source Overwrite edit on the Cut page.

IMPORTANT: The timecode of the Timeline must overlap the timecode of the clip(s) for this edit to function. This can be set in the Start Timecode field of the New Timeline settings.

To insert selected clips to timeline using timecode:

- 1 Select one or more clips to edit into the Timeline in the Media Pool. If there are In and Out points set on the clip, the edit will respect those boundaries. If no In/Out points are set, each selected clip's full duration will be edited in its entirety.
- 2 Set a destination control to determine which track in the Timeline you want to edit to.
- 3 Right-click one of the selected clips and choose "Insert Selected Clips to Timeline Using Timecode" from the drop-down menu.
- 4 All of the selected clips will be overwritten into the Timeline at their appropriate timecode locations onto the destination track.

IMPORTANT: If multiple selected clips have overlapping timecode, no edit will occur.

Insert Selected Clips to Timeline With Handles

This command inserts multiple clips into the Timeline serially, using the current sort order of the Media Pool, with handles subtracted from the current In and Out points of each clip (using the Default Handles Length in the Editing panel of the User Preferences). Combined with the Add Transition tool (Command-T), this function is useful when quickly creating montages from multiple clips.

To insert clips with handles to the Timeline:

- 1 Select the clips to insert into the Timeline with handles in the Media Pool.
- 2 Right-click any selected clip, then choose "Insert Selected Clips to Timeline With Handles." The clips will be inserted starting at the Timeline In point with the default handles length already calculated.

TIP: To finish creating the montage, select the clips in the Timeline, then choose “Add Transition” (Command-T) from the Timeline menu. This will apply the default transition to all of the clips at once.

Audio Track Creation While Editing

When dragging an audio clip to the undefined gray area of the Timeline below currently existing audio tracks in order to create a new track, the new track is set to a channel mapping that reflects the number of channels of the audio clip you’re dragging.

This also means that if you’ve used Clip Attributes to map a clip’s audio to consist of multiple tracks where each track has a different channel mapping, for example, one 5.1 track, one stereo track, and six mono tracks, then editing that clip into the Timeline so that the audio portion creates new tracks will automatically create eight tracks: one that’s 5.1, one that’s stereo, and six that are mono.

Not Creating New Tracks when Adding Clips to a Timeline

There is a menu item in Edit > Edit Options called Automatically Create Tracks on Edit. This option is on by default and preserves DaVinci Resolve’s default behavior of automatically adding new tracks to the timeline if your source material has more audio tracks than your timeline does.

When disabled, you have the ability to drag source clips on to the timeline without the timeline automatically creating new tracks for the additional audio or video elements. In situations where your source camera files have more audio tracks than on your timeline, disabling this option will not create additional new tracks and will only bring elements visible in the track destination controls.

This can be useful if, for example, you wanted to only bring a single mixed track in with a clip from a multitrack recorder and exclude the independent microphone tracks.

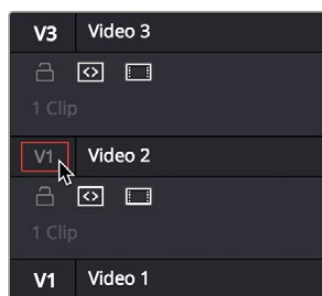
Using Keyboard Shortcuts and Three-Point Editing to Assemble a Program

While drag and drop editing is intuitive enough, there are other methods of editing clips into the Timeline by using the playhead to define where those clips will start that can be more efficient and precise. These examples all use “overwrite” edits, which delete unwanted media from the Timeline as you’re adding clips that you do want. Here are two examples of how to do this.

Example: Assembling Clips Into the Timeline From the Source Viewer

The following example shows how you can use the Edit page to assemble a quick first cut of edits using different features of the Media Pool, Viewers, and Timeline. Written out with every possible option, this may seem like a lot of steps, but once you learn these fundamentals and develop some muscle memory for the keyboard shortcuts in use, these methods become really fast to do.

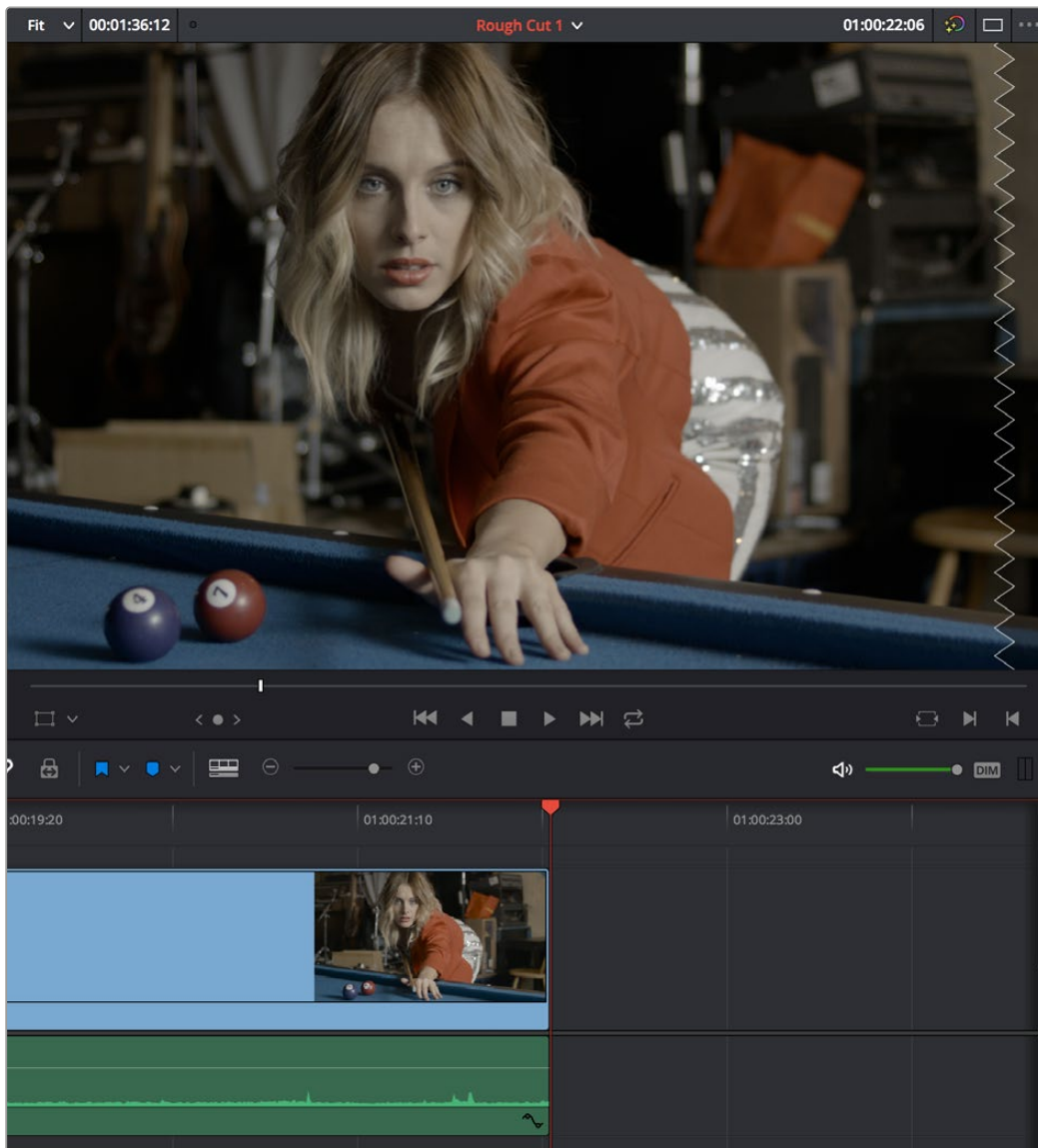
- 1 Press Command-1 to open the Bin list, and use the Arrow keys to select a bin (Up and Down to change the selection, Right and Left to open and close bins). Then press Command-2 to choose the clip browser, and use the Arrow keys to select a specific clip.
- 2 Press the Return or Enter key to open the selected clip into the Source Viewer.
- 3 Drag the playhead with the pointer or use the Spacebar or JKL keys to move the playhead and set In and Out points (I and O) to define the section of that clip you want to edit into your program.
- 4 By default, the destination controls are assigned to tracks V1 and A1. If necessary, choose different video and audio tracks to edit the clip to in the Timeline by doing one of the following:
 - Click the destination controls of the tracks you want to edit to. You can also drag them from where they are now to where you want them to be.
 - Use the Command-Option Up and Down Arrow (for audio) and Command-Shift Up and Down Arrow (for video) shortcuts to move the destination controls up and down.
 - Use the Option-1–8 (for video) and Command-Option-1–8 (for audio) key shortcuts to assign the video and audio destination controls to specific tracks.
- 5 By default, all destination controls are enabled. If you want to edit clips into the Timeline as audio or video only, you can do one of the following:
 - Click any destination control itself to disable the video or audio component.
 - Press Option-1–8 (for video) or Command-Option-1–8 (for audio) for the currently assigned tracks to toggle the destination controls on those tracks on and off.



Setting the destination control to the track you want to edit into.

- 6 In the Timeline Viewer or the Timeline itself, use the pointer, Spacebar, or JKL controls to move the Timeline playhead to the frame you want the beginning of the clip you're about to edit to start. If no In or Out points are set in the Timeline, the playhead position is used as the In point by default.
- 7 To perform an overwrite edit, do one of the following:
 - Drag the clip from the Source Viewer to the Timeline Viewer and drop it on the Overwrite overlay. If you're in single viewer mode, this overlay only appears when you drag a clip from the Media Pool to the Timeline Viewer.
 - Click the Overwrite Clip button in the toolbar.
 - Choose Edit > Overwrite (or press F10).

The selected clip(s) are overwritten to the selected track at the position of the playhead, and the playhead automatically moves to the end of the newly edited clip, ready for you to perform another edit. If that clip is the last one on the Timeline, you'll see the last frame to the left of the playhead (with a jagged overlay at the right-hand side of the Timeline Viewer) instead of the black that is the actual frame after that clip. This makes it easier for you to line up the next edit. Otherwise, the playhead will show whatever frame happens to be at that point in time.



The Timeline playhead at the first frame after the clip you've just edited; the Timeline Viewer shows a jagged overlay at the right to let you know this isn't a real frame

- 8 To edit another clip, open the next clip you want to edit into the Source Viewer, set In and Out points, and use the Overwrite Clip button or command to edit it into the Timeline. Continue this process until you've edited together the assembly of edits you want.

Example: Assembling Clips Into the Timeline From the Media Pool

If you want, you can also edit clips directly into the Timeline from the Media Pool using a variety of commands. This can be a fast way of appending clips to the end of the Timeline (although you can also perform insert edits this way).

To edit one or more clips from the Media Pool to the Timeline:

- 1 Press Command-2 or click with the pointer to choose a clip in the Media Pool.
- 2 Set In and Out points for one or more clips in the Media Pool by doing one of the following:
 - In Metadata view, drag the pointer over a clip's thumbnail and use the I and O keys. If Live Media Preview is enabled in the Source Viewer, dragging over a clip's thumbnail mirrors the content in the Source Viewer.
 - In Thumbnail view, drag the pointer over a clip's thumbnail and use the I and O keys. If Live Media Preview is enabled in the Source Viewer, dragging over a clip's thumbnail mirrors the content in the Source Viewer.
 - In List view, drag over the Media Pool Filmstrip Viewer and use the I and O keys. If Live Media Preview is enabled in the Source Viewer, dragging over the filmstrip mirrors the content in the Source Viewer.
- 3 Change the sort order of the Media Pool's browser area to put the clips into the order in which you want them to appear. In Thumbnail view you can use the Sort Order menu, but in List view you can click the header of any metadata column to sort by that column's data.
- 4 Click, drag, use the Command-Option and Command-Shift Up and Down Arrow Key shortcuts, or use the Option-1–8 and Command-Option-1–8 key shortcuts to assign the video and audio destination controls to the tracks you want to edit the video and audio of the incoming clip(s) to. Click any destination control itself to disable it if you want to edit clips into the Timeline as audio or video only.
- 5 Select one or more clips you want to edit. Insert, overwrite, place on top, ripple overwrite, and append at end edits are all capable of editing multiple clips at once, while replace and fit to fill edits can only edit one clip at a time, and will only edit the first of multiple selected clips into the Timeline.
- 6 To perform the edit, do one of the following:
 - Use any of the editing commands in the Edit menu.
 - Use the equivalent keyboard shortcuts to Insert (F9), Overwrite (F10), Replace (F11), Place On Top (F12), Ripple Overwrite (Shift-F10), Fit to Fill (Shift-F11), or Append To End of Timeline (Shift-F12) the selected clips into the Timeline.
 - Right-click one or more selected clips in the Media Pool, and choose "Insert Selected Clips to Timeline" or "Append Selected Clips to Timeline."

The selected clip(s) are edited into the Timeline.

Making Selections in the Timeline

Once you've assembled a sequence of clips in the Timeline, you'll probably need to manipulate them further, moving, deleting, trimming, or otherwise adjusting the clips in the Timeline to make the edit play with the pacing and verve you require.

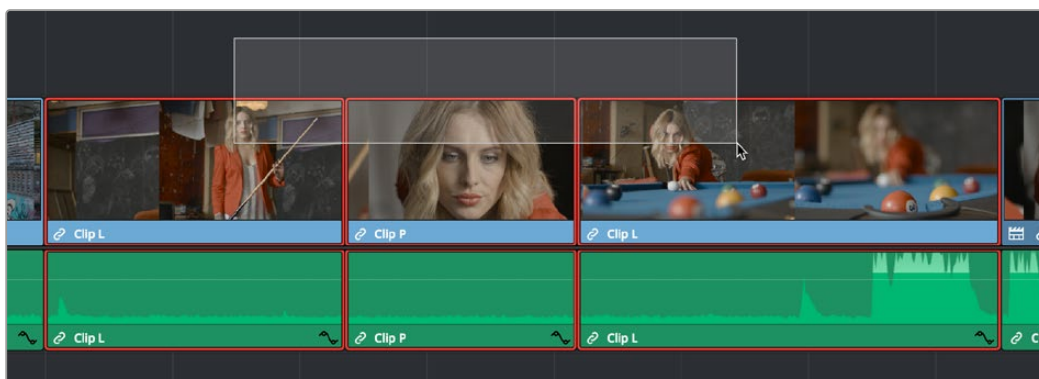
Manually Selecting Clips in the Timeline

Many operations require you to make a selection first, to define the scope of what you're about to do. There are many ways to do so.

Selections you can make using the mouse:

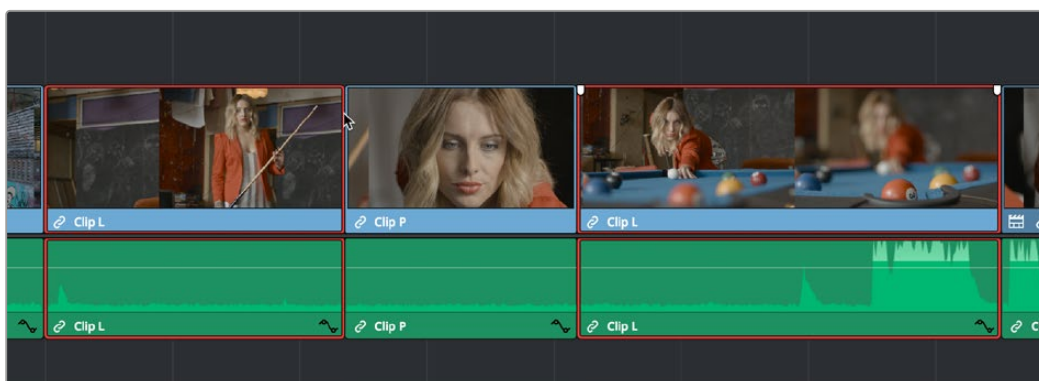
- **To select one clip:** Click a clip with the mouse.
- **To select all clips under the playhead:** You can select all the clips under the playhead at once, regardless of how many tracks they are spread across by selecting Trim > Select All Clips Under Playhead (Option-Shift-V).

- **To select a continuous range of clips by dragging:** Drag a bounding box from an empty area of the Timeline to surround a group of clips.



Dragging a bounding box to select a continuous range of clips in the Timeline

- **To select a continuous range of clips by Shift-clicking:** Click the first clip you want to select, and then Shift-click the last clip you want to select, and all clips in-between will automatically be selected as well.
- **To select a discontinuous range of clips:** Command-click any clips to select them no matter where they appear on the Timeline. Command-clicking a selected clip deselects it.



Command-clicking to select a discontinuous range of clips in the Timeline

Selecting clips using the keyboard or menu commands:

- **To select one clip:** Using the keyboard, make sure the Auto Select button for the track the clip is on is enabled, then move the playhead over that clip and press Shift-V.
- **To select a clip using keyboard navigation:** Holding down the Command key and pressing the Up, Down, Left, and Right Arrow keys allows you to select clips above and below the current track and to the left and right, independently of the playhead.
- **To select all clips forward of the playhead on the current track:** Move the playhead to the first clip you want to include in the selection, then press the Y key (Timeline > Select Clips Forward > On This Track) to select that clip and every clip to its right in the same track of the Timeline.
- **To select all clips forward of the playhead on all tracks:** Move the playhead to the first clip you want to include in the selection, then press Option-Y (Timeline > Select Clips Forward > On All Tracks) to select that clip and every clip to its right in all tracks of the Timeline.
- **To select all clips backward from the playhead on the current track:** Move the playhead to the last clip you want to include in the selection, then press Command-Y (Timeline > Select Clips Backward > On This Track) to select that clip and every clip to its left in the same track of the Timeline.

- **To select all clips backward from the playhead on all tracks:** Move the playhead to the last clip you want to include in the selection, then choose Command-Option-Y (Timeline > Select Clips Backward > On All Tracks) to select that clip and every clip to its left in all tracks of the Timeline.
- **To select all clips in the Timeline:** Make sure the Timeline has focus, then press Command-A.

To change which clip is selected using the keyboard:

- Select a clip, then use the Up Arrow and Down Arrow keys to change the selection to the previous or next clip among all tracks with Auto Select turned on.

Selecting Clips Based on Markers, Flags, and Clip Color

It's also possible to select multiple clips that have a particular color of marker, flag, or clip coloration. This is useful in any situation where you're using these organizational tools to keep track of clips with specific characteristics that you might need to later select for multi-clip operations.

For example, you might add purple markers to a series of audio clips that might need special EQ settings. Later, you can choose Timeline > Select Clips By Marker Color > Purple to select all of those clips in order to move them to another track, where you can apply the same EQ to all of them using an audio filter applied to the track. There are three ways of selecting groups of clips.

To select groups of clips based on marker, flag, or clip color:

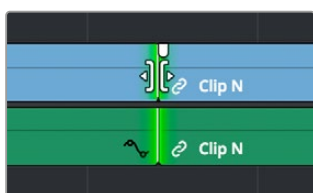
- Choose Timeline > Select Clips By Flag Color > Blue – Cream
- Choose Timeline > Select Clips By Marker Color > Blue – Cream
- Choose Timeline > Select Clips By Clip Color > Orange – Chocolate

Selecting Edits in the Timeline

A variety of editing and trimming methods require you to select an edit point, or part of an edit point, in order to resize, ripple, or roll an edit. You can do so using the mouse or using the keyboard.

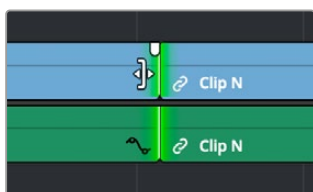
Methods for selecting edit points using the mouse:

- **To select an edit to roll:** Move the mouse to the center of an edit point, and when the ripple cursor appears, click to select the edit.



Selecting an edit point to roll

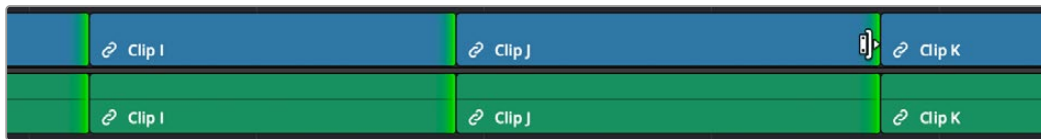
- **To select just the incoming or outgoing half of an edit point to resize or ripple:** Move the mouse to the left or right of the center of an edit, and when the resize/ripple cursor appears, click to select that portion of the edit.



Selecting incoming or outgoing halves of an edit point to resize or ripple

To select multiple edit points, do one of the following:

- **To select multiple roll points:** Command-click the center of multiple edit points. Command-click a selected edit point to deselect it.



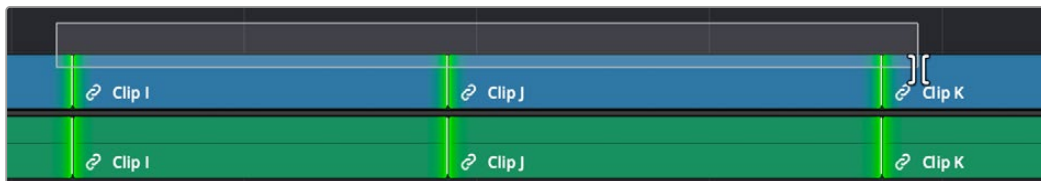
Command-clicking the center of several edits to prepare to roll them all

- **To select multiple ripple points:** Command-click the left or right sides of multiple edit points.



Command-clicking the left or right of several edits to ripple them all

- **To drag to select many edit points:** Select the Trim tool (T), and drag a bounding-box over the edit points you want to select. You can press U to switch all selected edit points among rippling incoming edits, rippling outgoing edits, and rolling edits.



Using the Trim tool, you can drag a bounding box to select multiple edits

There is also a flexible set of keyboard shortcuts that makes it easy to select edit points in preparation for various operations if you like to avoid using the mouse.

Keyboard shortcuts for selecting edits:

V: Selects the nearest edit point to the playhead on the lowest track with Auto Select enabled. Selects both the audio and video edit points of a clip together.

Option-E: Selects the nearest video edit point to the playhead on the lowest track with Auto Select enabled. Linked audio edit points are not selected.

Shift-E: Selects the nearest audio edit point to the playhead on the lowest track with Auto Select enabled. Linked video edit points are not selected.

U: Once you've selected an edit point, this shortcut toggles among selecting the outgoing half, incoming half, or the entire edit.

Option-U: Once you've selected an edit point, this shortcut toggles among selecting the video+audio of the edit, just the video, or just the audio.

To move the selection to another edit:

- Select a single edit point, then use the Up Arrow key (Previous Edit) or Down Arrow key (Next Edit) to change the selection to the previous or next edit point among all tracks with Auto Select turned on.

To deselect all edit points:

- **Using the mouse:** Click any empty area of the Timeline.
- **Using the keyboard:** Press Shift-Command-A.

A Practical Example of Keyboard-Driven Selections

Here's an example of how you would use these keyboard shortcuts together as a sequence of operations.

To select an edit point using the keyboard:

- 1 Press Command-4 to give focus to the Timeline.
- 2 Move the Timeline playhead close to the edit point you want to select using the JKL keys.
- 3 Press the V key to select the nearest edit point to the playhead on the lowest track with Auto Select enabled. If there are overlapping superimposed clips on multiple tracks, turn off the Auto Select controls of tracks with edits you don't want to select using Option-F1 through Option-F8 corresponding to the Auto Select controls on tracks 1–8. Using the mouse, you can solo a track's Auto Select state by Option-clicking its Auto Select button. (Option-F9 toggles the Auto Select controls of all video tracks.)
- 4 Initially, the entire edit is selected, in preparation for a roll edit. To toggle among selecting the outgoing half, incoming half, and the entire edit, press the U key.
- 5 To toggle among selecting the video+audio of the edit, just the video, or just the audio, press Option-U.
- 6 Perform whatever operation you need to. When you're finished, using Up-Arrow or Down-Arrow to move the selection backward or forward in the Timeline, or press Command-Shift-A to deselect it.

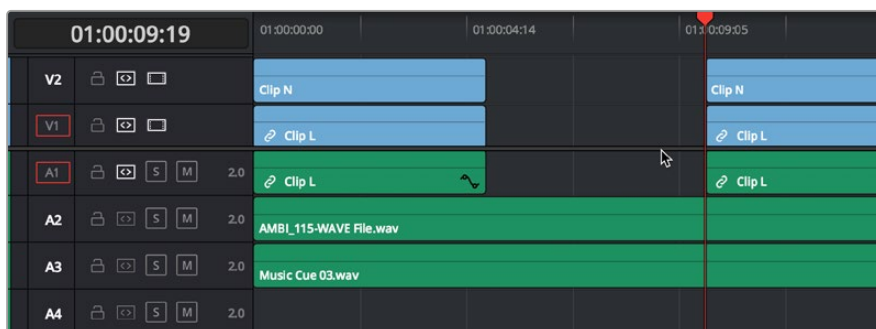
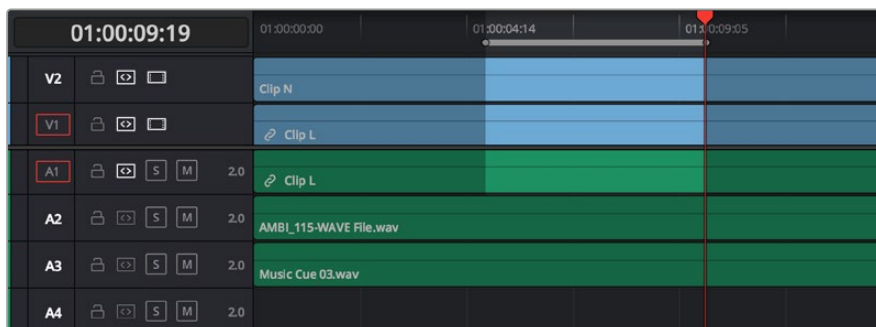
Using Auto Select Controls to Define Selections

The Timeline Auto Select controls are extremely useful and versatile controls that serve many purposes. In short, they give you a way to specify which tracks will be affected or considered when you're performing an operation upon multiple superimposed clips on multiple tracks of the Timeline.

Also, the Timeline Auto Select controls are particularly convenient when you're using keyboard shortcuts to edit and you don't want to have to grab your mouse to explicitly select a single clip, since you can turn Auto Select on or off via keyboard shortcuts.

Defining Selections With the Help of Auto Select Controls

Here is the easiest example of when the Auto Select controls are indispensable. In the following example, there are two superimposed video clips and three superimposed audio clips. Supposing you only want to delete the media from tracks V2, V1, and A1, but you want to leave the media on A2 and A3 alone, you can turn off the Auto Select controls for tracks A2 and A3, and set Timeline In and Out points to define the range of the clips you want to delete. When you press the Delete key, only the media on the Auto Select-enabled tracks is deleted.

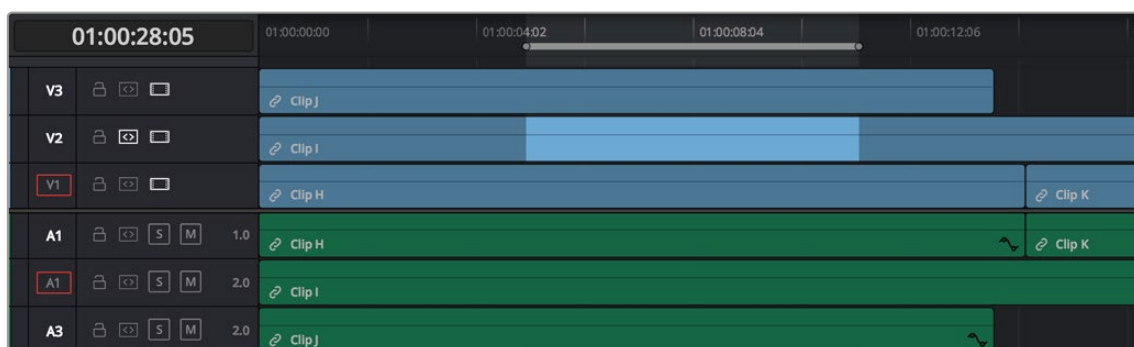


Before and After deleting a clip with Auto Select on Tracks A2, A3, and A4 turned off

TIP: If you set In and Out points to perform an operation and you don't see any shading in the Timeline to indicate which parts of the Timeline will be affected and which won't, chances are you have another selected clip in the Timeline somewhere you can't see that's overriding auto select. Press Command-Shift-A to de-select all and things should go back to normal.

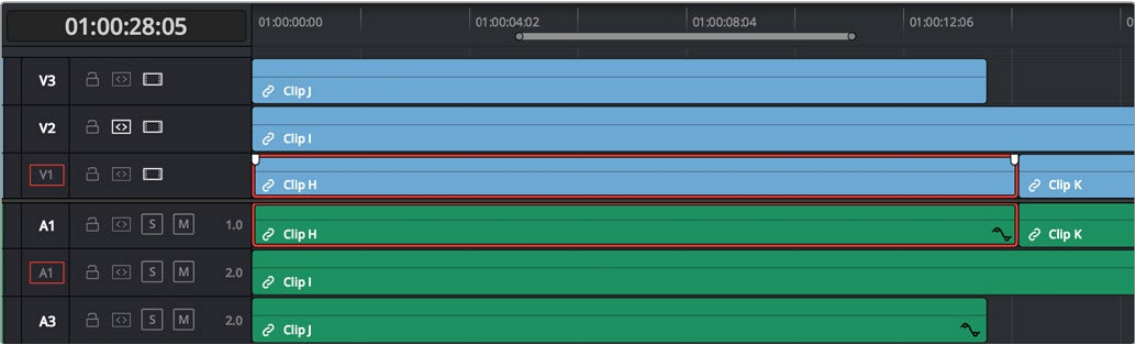
Overriding Automatic Selections by Making Manual Selections

It's important to note that manual selections that you make which highlight specific clips in the Timeline always override whatever the Auto Select control of a track is set to. In the following example, three clips are superimposed and the Auto Select control of every track except V2 has been turned off. Setting Timeline In and Out points now automatically defines that region of the clip on track V2 to be deleted were you to press the Delete key. You can see the affected part of the Timeline because it's highlighted while the rest of the Timeline is dimmed.



Soloing the Auto Select control on track V2 to limit a Delete operation

However, if you clicked the clip on track V1 to select it manually, the automatic selection defined by the In and Out points disappears in favor of the highlighted clip you just clicked. This is because manual selections almost always take precedence over automatic selections you define using the In and Out points and Auto Select controls.



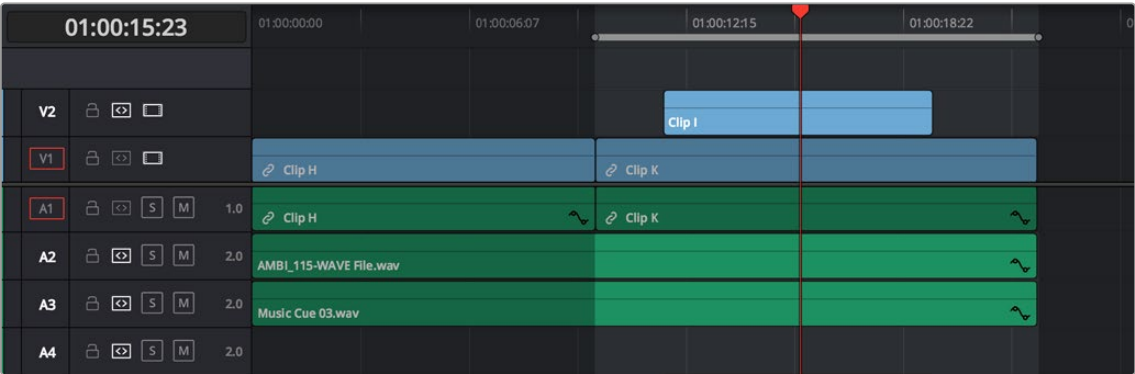
Making a manual selection overrides the Auto Select controls

This is good to keep in mind for situations where the fastest way to do the operation you need to do is to simply manually select the clip you want to define the operation.

Using Auto Select Controls to Control Other Operations

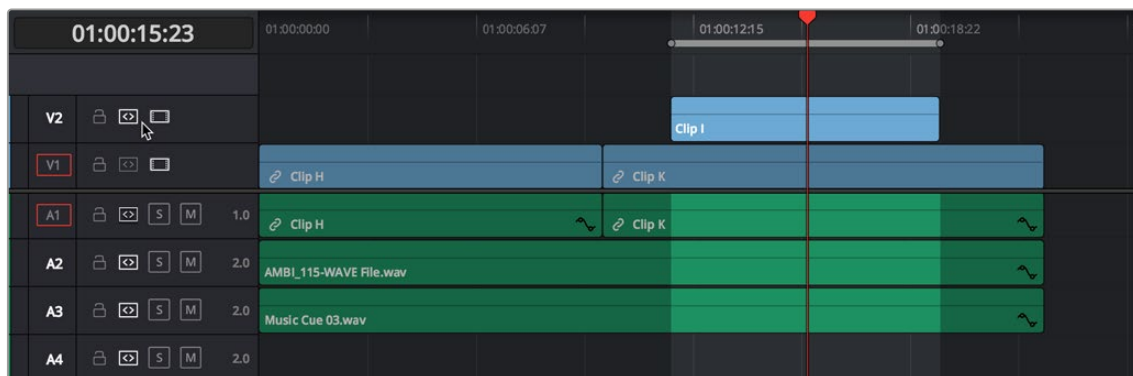
Other operations that are affected by the Auto Select controls include any command that uses “the clip on the lowest-numbered track with Auto Select enabled” to define what happens. This includes Copy and Paste, Mark Clip, Go To Next Edit/Previous Edit, the Selection Follows Playhead mode, Next Gap/Previous Gap, and so on (a full list of affected operations appears later).

A common example of when this is important is whenever you use the Mark Clip command to automatically set In and Out points to match the duration of a clip on the Timeline. If that clip happens to be at a section of the Timeline where there are multiple superimposed clips, each of which has a different duration, then by default the In and Out points (first and last frames) of the clip on the lowest numbered track is used to set Timeline In and Out points when you use Mark Clip.



Using Mark Clip with all Auto Select controls enabled, the clip on the lowest-numbered video track with Auto Select enabled defines the result

However, if you disable the Auto Select control of track V1, then whichever clip is on the lowest video track with Auto Select still enabled is used as the target clip for the Mark Clip operation. In this example, the shorter clip on track V2 now sets the locations of the In and Out points.



Using Mark Clip with Auto Select controls enabled

Methods of enabling and disabling the Auto Select controls:

- **To toggle Auto Select for any track:** Click any track's Auto Select control.
- **To toggle Auto Select for video tracks:** Press Option-F1 through F8 to toggle Auto Select on the corresponding tracks.
- **To toggle Auto Select for audio tracks:** Press Option-Command-F1 through F8 to toggle Auto Select on the corresponding tracks.
- **To toggle all video track Auto Select tracks off and on:** Press Option-F9.
- **To toggle all audio track Auto Select tracks off and on:** Press Option-Command-F9.
- **To “solo” Auto Select for a track and disable Auto Select on all other tracks:** Option-click any Auto Select control to leave that control on while turning off all other Auto Select controls of that type (video or audio).
- **To turn all audio or video Auto Select controls on and off:** Shift-click any video or audio Auto Select control to toggle on or off all Auto Select controls of that type (video or audio).

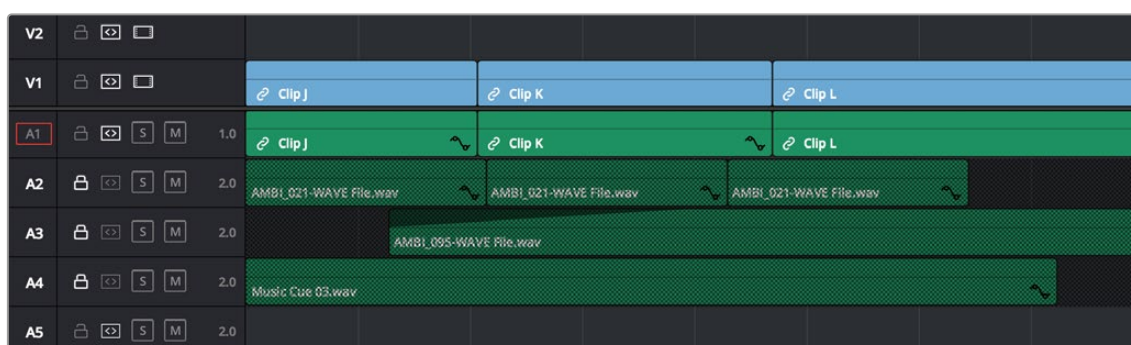
The following operations are affected by the state of each track's Auto Select control:

- **Cutting, ripple cutting, copying, or deleting clips:** When using Timeline In and Out points to delete a range of media from the Timeline, only media on tracks with an enabled Auto Select control will be cut, copied, or deleted.
- **Deleting gaps:** When selecting and deleting gaps in the Timeline, clips on other tracks that overlap the selected gap will also be deleted on tracks with an enabled Auto Select control. Media to the right of affected tracks will ripple left to close the gap.
- **Selecting edit points using the keyboard:** When you press V to select the nearest edit point, the edit point on the lowest track with Auto Select enabled is selected. When pressing the Up Arrow and Down Arrow keys to move the selection from edit point to edit point, edit points on tracks with a disabled Auto Select control are ignored.
- **Selecting clips using the keyboard:** When a clip is selected, you can press the Up Arrow and Down Arrow keys to move the selection from clip to edit clip, but clips on tracks with a disabled Auto Select control are not seen by this operation.
- **Using Mark Clip:** When using the Mark Clip command, clips on tracks with disabled Auto Select controls are ignored. This lets you choose a target clip to use for marking the clip when there are multiple overlapping superimposed clips.
- **Match Frame:** When making a Match Frame operation, clips on tracks with disabled Auto Select controls are ignored. This lets you choose a target clip to use for matching a frame when there are multiple overlapping superimposed clips.
- **Rippling the Timeline during a trim operation:** Tracks with Auto Select turned off will not be rippled. For more information on the rules of ripple trimming, see *Chapter 44, “Trimming.”*

- **Pasting clips:** All copied clips will be pasted to the lowest numbered track with Source Control enabled. If all tracks of a particular type have their Auto Select controls turned off, then no clips of that type will be pasted at all.
- **Paste Insert:** Tracks with Auto Select turned off will not be rippled or affected by clips being pasted via a Paste Insert command.
- **Using the insert or ripple overwrite edits:** Only clips on tracks with Auto Select turned on will be rippled during an insert edit or ripple overwrite edit.
- **Finding gaps:** When using Playback > Previous Gap (Command-Option-Semicolon) or Next Gap (Command-Option-Apostrophe), gaps on tracks with Auto Select disabled will be ignored.
- **Using Selection Follows Playhead:** When you turn on “Selection Follows Playhead” so that the clip intersecting the position of the playhead is automatically selected. If multiple clips are intersecting the playhead, the clip on the highest track will be selected. Clips on tracks with Auto Select disabled will not be selected.

Locking Tracks You Don't Want to Change

Another step you can take to prepare before performing any kind of editorial operation is to lock tracks with media that you don't want to be affected by whatever it is you're about to do. For example, if you have a complex set of music edits on track A3 that you don't want to be affected by operations that will ripple the Timeline, you can lock track A3 so those clips remain unaffected.



Tracks V2, V1, and A1 are unlocked, while tracks A2, A3, and A4 are locked

Clips on locked tracks cannot be moved, deleted, cut, or otherwise affected by editorial operations. Furthermore, parameters of locked clips cannot be edited in the Inspector. However, clips on locked tracks can be graded and otherwise modified in the Color page.

To toggle the lock or unlock state of tracks, do one of the following:

- Click any track's lock control to toggle lock on and off.
- Shift-click any track's lock control to toggle locking on and off for all tracks.
- Press Option-Shift-1 through 8 to lock or unlock tracks V1 through V8.
- Press Option-Shift-9 to lock or unlock all video tracks.
- Press Option-Shift-F1 through F8 to lock or unlock tracks A1 through A8.
- Press Option-Shift-F9 to lock or unlock all audio tracks.

Position Lock for Finishing

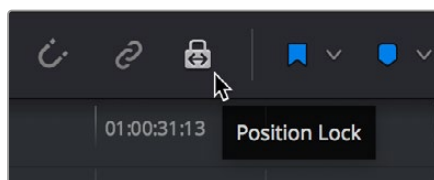
In a nutshell, turning position lock on prevents clips from being moved to the left or right, and it prevents all ripple operations. This is primarily useful when you're near the end of post on a project for which the cut has been locked (or at least as "locked" as directors and producers allow any more), but you still need to make surgical changes that don't risk throwing the video out of sync with audio that may be being edited and mixed elsewhere because of an accidentally rippled edit.

With position lock on, you can still make edits (such as Replace), slip clips, roll edits, add Resolve FX and other Open FX, and alter all manner of effects in the Inspector. You just can't do anything that alters the position of clips in the Timeline, or ripples entire sections of the Timeline.

There are two ways you can enable Position Lock.

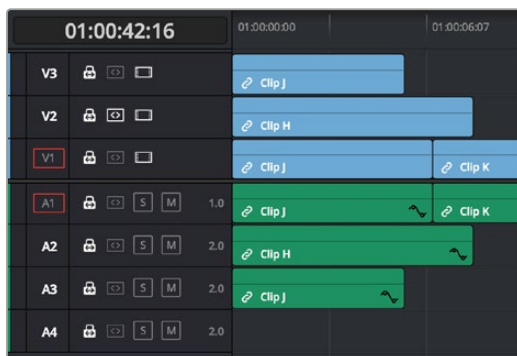
Position Locking All Tracks

You can turn Position Lock on and off for all tracks via a button in the toolbar above the Timeline.



The Position Lock button on the toolbar

When you turn position lock on, the Lock button of all tracks changes to show that position lock is enabled instead.

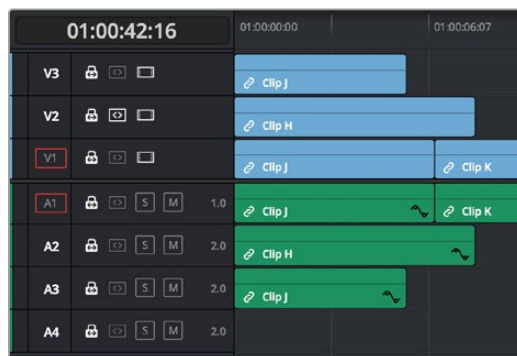


Position lock indicated by each track's Lock icon changing

Position Locking Individual Tracks

You can also be extra tricky and enable position lock on a track-by-track basis by Command-clicking any track's Lock button.

Position lock can be released by simply clicking that track's Lock icon.

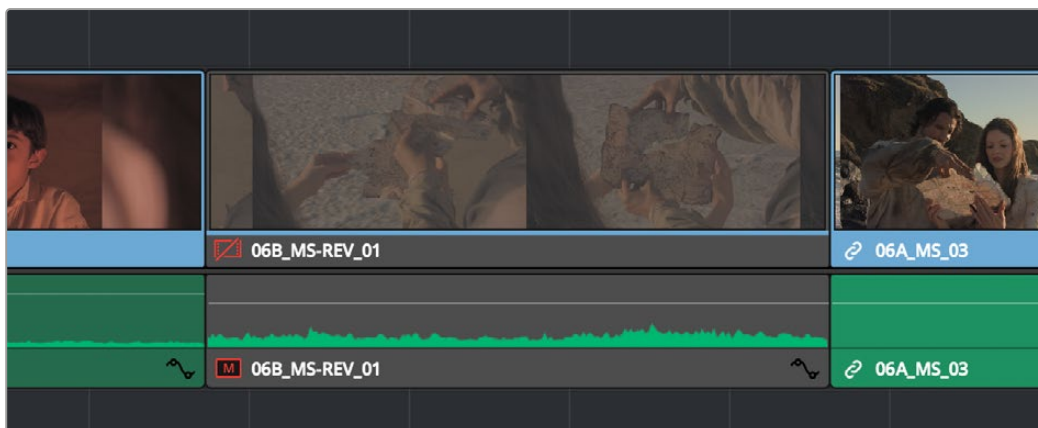


Command-click any track's Lock button to put that track into Position Lock mode

Disabling and Re-Enabling Clips in the Timeline

Sometimes there's one or more video or audio clips in the Timeline that you don't want to play along with the rest of the edited sequence, but you don't want to remove from the Timeline either, in case you change your mind later. For this reason, it's possible to Disable clips, effectively turning them off without removing them.

Disabled clips appear dimmed in the Timeline. They don't play back, they're not rendered, and they're not output to video. However, their position is preserved in the Timeline, so you can always re-enable them at a later time if you change your mind and decide you want to use them.



A clip that's been disabled between two enabled clips; the disabled clip is dimmed

To disable or re-enable one or more selected clips:

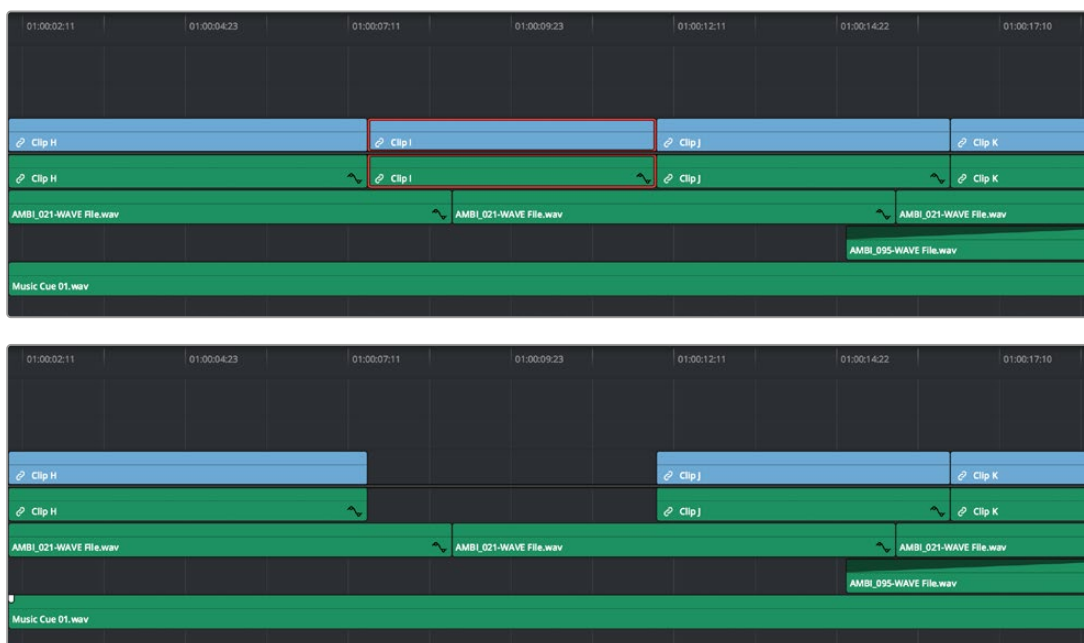
- Right-click part of the selection and choose Enable Clip from the contextual menu.
- Choose Clip > Enable Clip.
- Press D.

Deleting Clips and Gaps From the Timeline

There are two ways you can delete clips you don't want in the Timeline. Using the Delete key, you can perform what's sometimes called a "lift edit," removing the unwanted clips and leaving a gap. Using the Forward Delete key, you can perform a "ripple delete," removing unwanted clips and closing the gap by rippling the rest of the edited Timeline to the right of the deleted clip(s) by moving it to the left.

Deleting clips as a "lift edit" operation:

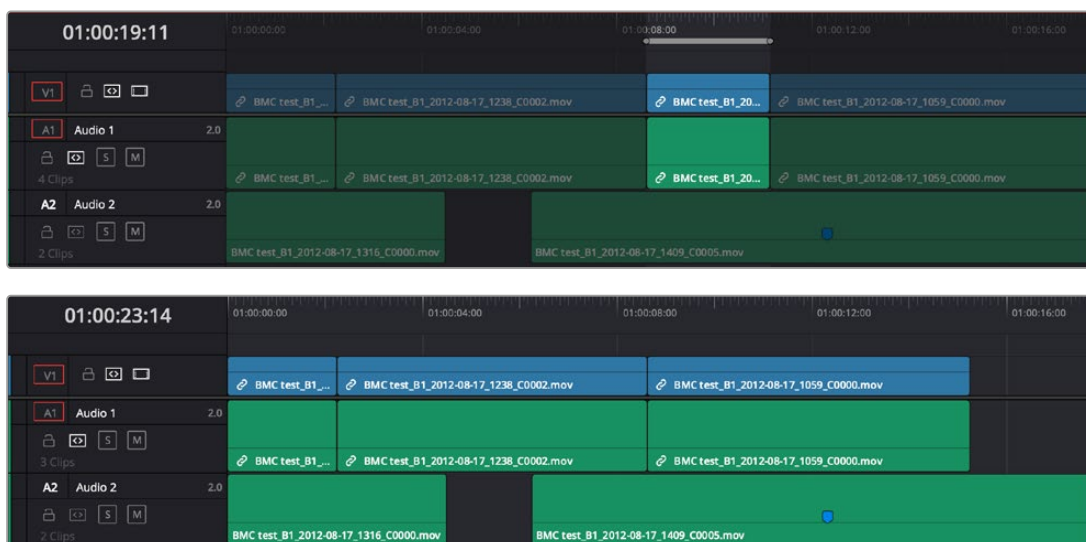
- **To remove one or more clips from the Timeline, leaving a gap:** Select a clip in the Timeline, or Shift-click or Command-click to select the clips you want to remove, and press the Delete key (or right-click the selection and choose Delete).
- **To remove a range of media from the Timeline on multiple tracks, leaving a gap:** Set Timeline In and Out points defining the range of media you want to delete, then turn off the Auto Select controls of any tracks with media you want to preserve, and press the Delete key (or right-click the selection and choose Delete).



Deleting Clip I using the Backspace or Delete key and leaving a gap

Deleting clips as a "ripple delete" operation:

- **To delete one or more clips and close the gap by rippling the Timeline left:** Select a clip in the Timeline, or Shift-click or Command-click to select the clips you want to remove, and press the Forward Delete key.
- **To delete a range of media and close the gap by rippling the Timeline left:** Set Timeline In and Out points defining the range of media you want to delete, then turn off the Auto Select controls of any tracks with media you want to preserve, and press the Forward Delete key.



Deleting Clip I using the Forward Delete key to ripple all clips with In points to the right in the Timeline to close the gap

As with any ripple operation, all clips with In points to the right of the deleted range of media on tracks with auto select enabled are rippled to close the gap, and any clips with In points to the left of the In point of the affected range of media are unaffected.

Finding, Selecting, and Deleting Gaps in the Timeline

A gap is defined as a space between any two clips on the same track. Often gaps are desirable as they allow audio or video clips to be spaced apart from one another very specifically, but sometimes they're not. If you want to find accidental gaps in your timeline that may be too small to see, a pair of commands lets you do this.

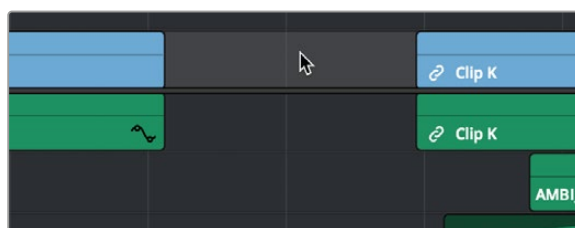
To move the playhead to the next gap on the Timeline:

- 1 Turn off the Auto Select controls of any tracks you want to omit from this operation.
- 2 Do one of the following:
 - Choose Playback > Previous Gap, or press Option-Command-Semicolon (;) to move the playhead to the next gap to the left of the playhead's current position.
 - Choose Playback > Next Gap, or press Option-Command-Apostrophe (') to move the playhead to the next gap to the right of the playhead's current position.

To select or deselect a gap:

Click once to select a gap, and click that gap again to deselect it.

You can only select one gap at a time. The principal reason to select a gap is to delete it, in the process rippling the Timeline to close the gap. In the following example, there's a gap between two clips on track V1 that you'd like to close.



Selecting a gap on track V1

To delete a gap:

Press the Delete key to close the gap. All clips to the right of it on tracks with Auto Select enabled will be rippled to the left to close the gap. Clips on tracks with Auto Select disabled will not ripple.

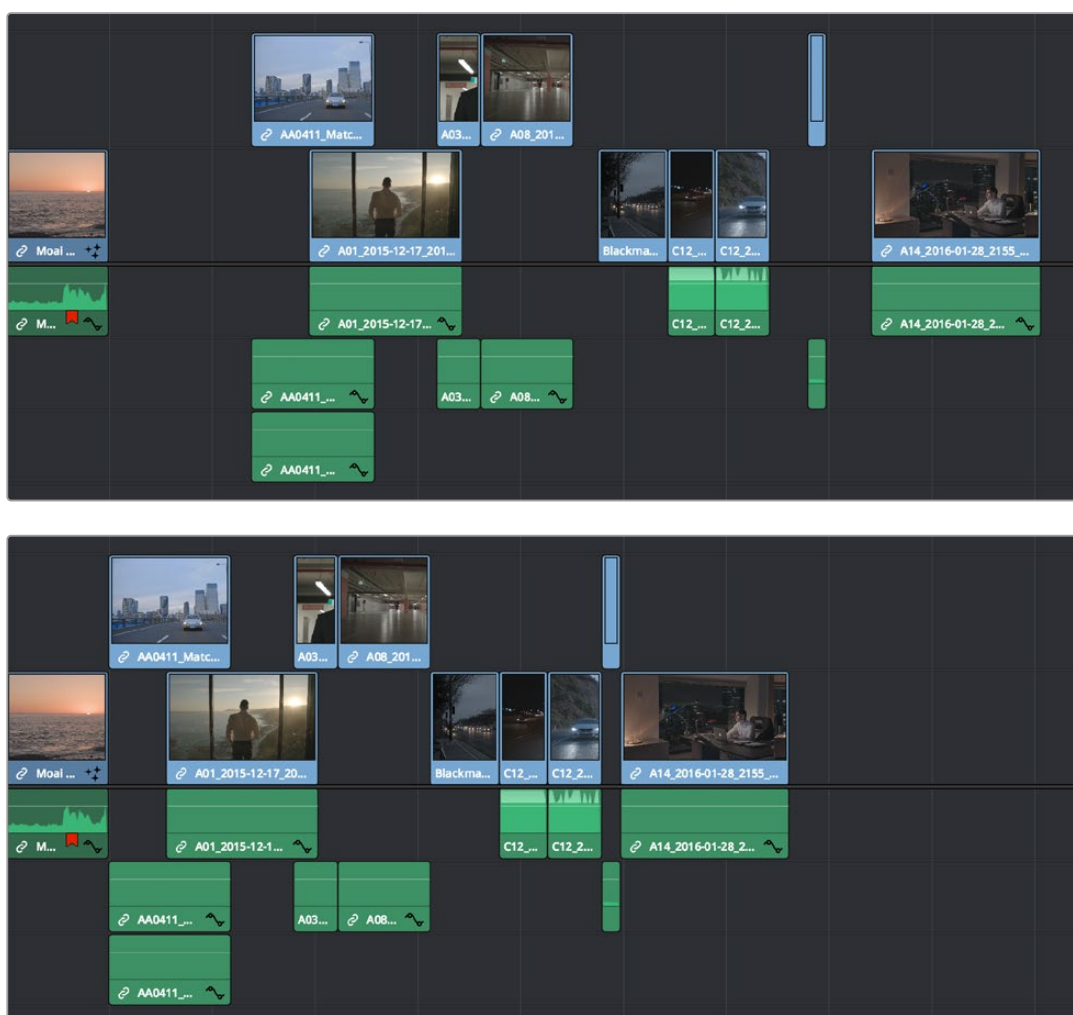
If you select a gap in a timeline with clips on multiple tracks, which clips will be deleted depends on the state of the Auto Select controls for each track in the Timeline.

- **All tracks with Auto Select enabled:** The range of media that overlaps the selected gap will also be deleted. Clips on those tracks will ripple left to fill the gap.
- **All tracks with Auto Select disabled:** The range of media that overlaps the selected gap will be left intact, and clips on those tracks will not ripple left, going out of sync with whichever clips do ripple.

Deleting Multiple Timeline Gaps at Once

You can also ripple-delete video and audio gaps in the Timeline all at once using the Edit > Delete Gaps command. This removes gaps among consecutive clips in the Timeline on all Auto Select enabled tracks. Each segment of the Timeline with a gap is rippled, in order to move clips that are to the right of each gap left to close that gap.

All gaps are defined for purposes of this command as empty spaces between clips that span all tracks in the Timeline. In the following example, various audio/video, audio-only, and video-only clips have gaps between them. Using Remove Gaps causes the Timeline to be rippled such that these clips abut one another as a continuous sequence, without any of them overlapping any others.



(Top) Before removing gaps, (Bottom) After removing gaps

This is an extremely powerful and wide-ranging command. However, it's made safer by following strict rules in order to maintain overall A/V sync in timelines:

- Gaps will not be removed past the point where video and/or audio clips will overlap one another.
- Gaps will not be removed if they're under superimposed video clips that bridge the gap.
- Gaps will not be removed if one or more continuous audio clips bridge the gap.
- You can limit the range of the gaps to be deleted by setting In/Out points on the Timeline.
- If a linked set of video and audio items has a gap that includes an L or J split edit, it will be closed to the point that the audio or video, whichever extends the farthest, abuts the nearest clip to it.

Disabling a track's Auto Select Control omits that track from consideration when following the above rules. This lets gaps on other tracks be closed so clips overlap those on the Auto Select-disabled track.

WARNING: Performing Remove Gaps with Auto Select disabled on one or more tracks could result in massive loss of video/audio sync if you're not careful. To avoid this, Shift-click one video Auto Select control (or press Option-F9) and one audio Auto Select control (or press Command-Option-F9) to toggle all video and all audio Auto Select controls until they're all turned on at once.

Audio/Video Linking

DaVinci Resolve gives you complete control over the linked relationship between the video and audio associated with a clip. By default, DaVinci Resolve tries its best to keep the video and audio of clips and timelines in sync. However, there are several ways you can suspend automatic syncing when you need to make a specific kind of edit.

Controlling Linked Selection

While selecting edits and clips, you can also choose whether the video and audio associated with a clip should be selected together (linked) or not. This determines whether operations performed to the video of a clip automatically affect the audio of the clip, and vice versa. In most instances, you'll probably want to leave Linked Selection turned on, so that selecting the video of a clip to move it elsewhere in the Timeline also results in the audio being selected and moved at the same time. Disabling A/V linking in this case could cause your video and audio to go out of sync undesirably.

However, there are plenty of instances when you'll want to temporarily suspend this linked A/V relationship, such as when you want to create a split edit, where a clip's audio In point is at a different frame than the video In point. In this case, you can suspend Linked Selection to select just the audio In point, then roll it either farther back or forward to create the split, without changing the In point of that clip's video. When you're finished, you can re-enable A/V linking.

At all times, the state of Linked Selection is visible via the Chain-link button at the right of the toolbar.



The Link Audio/Video button

To turn Linked Selection off and on:

- Click the Link Audio/Video button (or press Shift-Command-L).

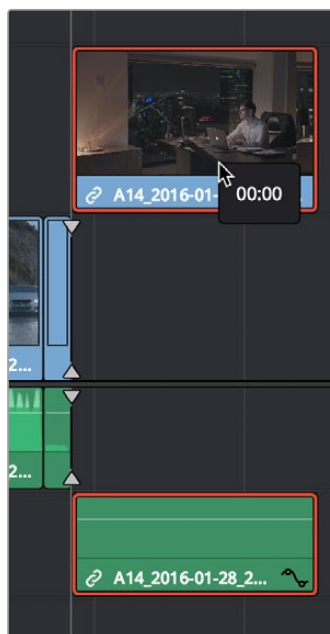
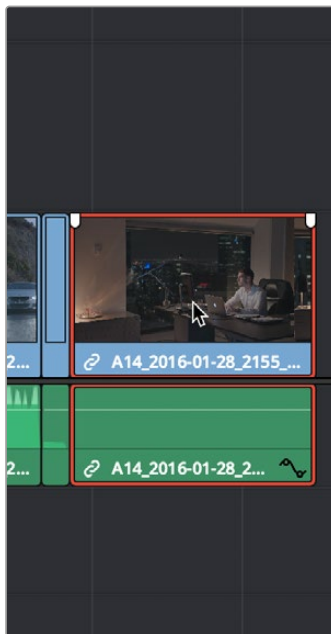
To temporarily suspend Linked Selection while making a selection:

- Press the Option key while clicking a clip or edit point to select the video without selecting the audio, or vice versa.

Linked Move Across Tracks

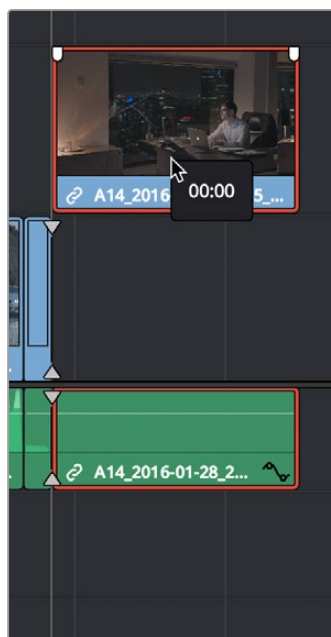
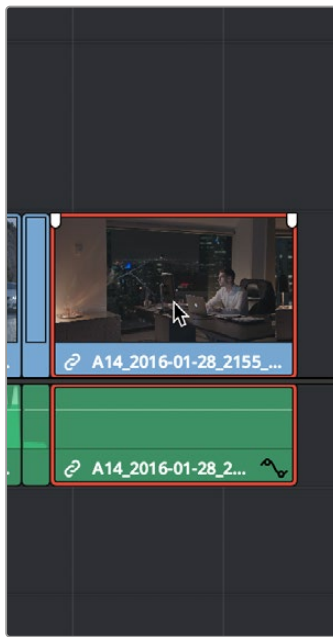
The Timeline > Linked Move Across Tracks setting works in conjunction with Linked Selection to let you change how linked video and audio items move in the Timeline when you drag them up and down to reorganize clips from track to track. Depending on the task at hand, one or the other behaviors might be more convenient, but no matter how you have this mode set, video/audio sync is always maintained when you move clips left and right.

- **When Linked Move Across Tracks is enabled:** (On by default) Dragging one of a linked pair of video and audio items up or down in the Timeline moves the linked item up or down as well. So, moving a video clip from track V1 to V2 results in its linked audio clip moving from track A1 to A2 as well.



Before and after with Linked Move Across Tracks enabled; if video clip is moved, the linked audio clip moves simultaneously

- **When Linked Move Across Tracks is disabled:** Dragging one of a linked pair of video and audio items up or down to another track in the Timeline only moves that one item, other linked item(s) remain in the same track. So, moving a video clip from track V1 to V2 leaves the audio clip in track A1, where it was originally. This makes it easy to reorganize video clips into different tracks while leaving your audio clips organized the way they were, or vice versa. Keep in mind that in this mode, while you can move one item of a linked pair up and down freely, moving that item left or right results in all linked items moving by the same amount, so sync is maintained.

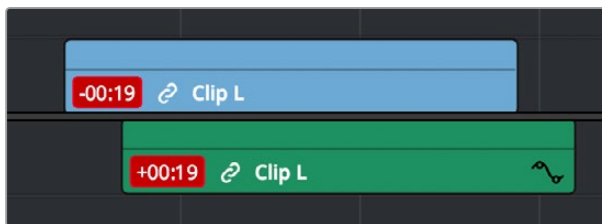


Before and after with Linked Move Across Tracks disabled; if the video clip is moved, the linked audio clip remains in its original position or vice versa

Dealing with Audio Video Sync Offsets

Audio/video sync is one of the most important things to maintain in any edited program. However, there are times when you may want to override the sync relationship of a clip's audio and video to make a particular edit, so moving a clip's audio and video out of sync is allowed.

If you disable Linked Selection and then move the audio or video of a clip independently of its linked video or audio counterpart, you'll see red "out-of-sync" indicators at the left of each clip's name bar, that displays the timecode offset by which the audio and video of that clip are out of sync. In the following example, the audio and video of a clip have been moved out of sync by Option-clicking the video and dragging it to the left.

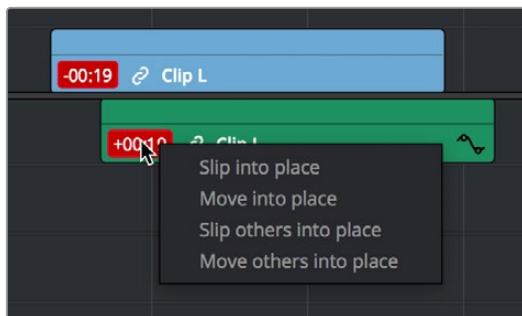


Sync markers on a clip with audio and video out of sync

If you've moved the audio and video of a clip out of sync with one another, there's a really easy way of getting them back into sync, by right-clicking the red out-of-sync indicator of any clip and choosing one of the available commands:

- **Slip into place:** Slips the content of the selected clip, without moving the clip, so that it's in sync with the other items that are linked to that clip.
- **Move into place:** Moves the selected clip so that it's in sync with the other items that are linked to that clip.
- **Slip others into place:** Slips the content of all other items that are linked to the selected clip, without moving them, so that all linked items are in sync.

- **Move others into place:** Moves all other items that are linked to the selected clip so that all linked items are in sync.



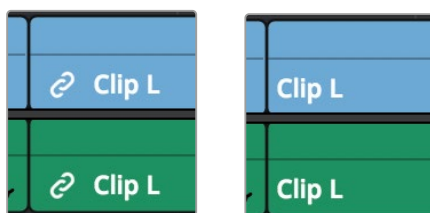
Commands in the contextual menu of sync tooltips

Manually Unlinking and Relinking Audio and Video

By default, clips that you import into DaVinci Resolve have their video and audio linked together, which makes it easy to maintain the relationship and sync of the audio and video components of a clip while you're editing. However, there are many reasons you might want to override this automatic relationship, either breaking the A/V linking of a clip's audio and video completely, or breaking it and relinking in a different way, or to different clips.

Methods of permanently changing audio/video linking in the Timeline:

- **To unlink audio and video from one another:** Select a clip, then right-click it and choose Link from the contextual menu (or press Option-Command-L). Unlinked clips do not appear with a chain icon before the clip name in the Timeline.
- **To link audio and video clips to one another:** Command-click an audio clip and a video clip so they're both selected, then right-click the selected clips and choose Link from the contextual menu (or press Option-Command-L). A chain icon appears before the name of linked clips in the Timeline.



(Left) linked video and audio with a chain icon to the left of the clip name, (Right) unlinked audio and video items have no icon.

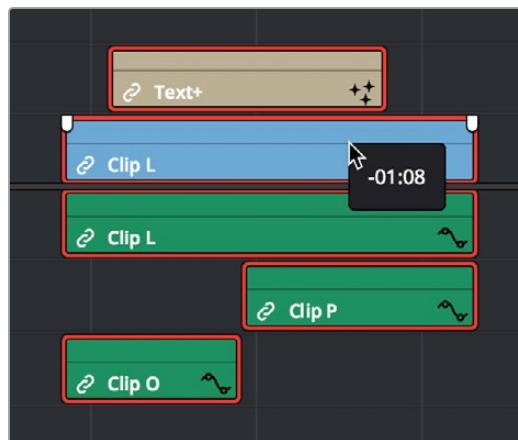
Linking Multiple Clips in the Timeline

You don't just have to link audio and video clips that sync together, though. You can actually link any number of video and audio clips that you want to be able to select, move, and edit together as one, even if they were never originally meant to be synced. This makes linking an organizational mechanism as much as a sync management tool.

Here are some examples of how you can use this:

- You can link a text generator with a subtitle to the clip it plays along with.
- You can link a sandwich of overlapping audio sound effects with the video clip they accompany.
- You can link off camera audio to an on camera shot.
- You can link the background and foreground clips of a green screen composite, with sound from both.

Linking multiple clips in the Timeline works the same as linking a single audio and video clip together; every single linked item appears with a chain icon to the left of the clip name, and suspending linked selection to force any single clip out of sync will result in the display of an “out-of-sync” indicator.



Multiple audio and video items that have been manually linked together to act as a single clip in the Timeline when Linked Selection is enabled

Commands for Slipping Audio/Video Sync

Another set of commands in the Trim > Slip Audio submenu let you slip the contents of one or more selected clips in order to alter the sync between the audio and video, either in whole frame increments, or in sub-frame increments if there are clips with marginal sync that you want to improve.

- One Frame Forward (Option-Period)
- One Frame Reverse (Option-Comma)
- One Subframe Forward (Option-Right Arrow)
- One Subframe Reverse (Option-Left Arrow)